Haochen Ni

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Research Interests

Microeconomic Theory, Game Theory, Information Economics, Mechanism Design, Behavioural Theory.

Education

University College London **Sep 2024 – Jun 2027**
BSc Economics – Expected First-Class Honours
Second-year average: 78.8/100

Relevant Modules

Mathematics: Real Analysis (91.1), Advanced Linear Algebra (88.1).
Economics: Microeconomics (78.4), Econometrics (74.9), Macroeconomics (72.3).
Current/Forthcoming Modules: Game Theory and Information Economics, Advanced Econometrics and Data Science, Multivariable Analysis, Metric Spaces.
Additional Training: Auditing UCL MRes Microeconomics, MRes Real Analysis and Probability, and Measure Theory, 2026-2027.

Research Papers

Partial Universalisation in Threshold Public Goods: Actions to Inclinations
Working Paper, 2026
- Developed a theory of partial Kantian reasoning in finite threshold public-good environments, where contemplated strategies are probabilistically linked to the behaviour of like-minded agents.
- Established a collective pivotality representation: the pure-contribution premium equals the probability that the contribution-oriented counterfactual reaches the provision threshold while the abstention-oriented does not.
- Proved that collective pivotality is strictly single-peaked in background cooperation for every admissible finite threshold, generating a bounded contribution region under intermediate contribution costs.
- Extended the model from pure commitments to mixed-strategy contribution inclinations, and proved that, for every admissible group size and threshold, a non-empty open parameter region supports a unique interior optimum.

A Structural Theory of the Willingness-to-Pay Gap: Valuation and Behaviour in Climate Mitigation
UCL Journal of Economics, Volume 5, Issue 1, October 2026
Selected for presentation at UCL Explore Econ 2026.
- Developed a common utility framework distinguishing Hicksian welfare valuation from voluntary contributions.
- Established that valuation and contribution can diverge under stable preferences and rational choice.
- Analysed how observability and social-image incentives shape the relationship between valuation and contributions.
- Proposed a limited-attention interpretation of cheap-talk scripts, under which reminders about budgets and opportunity costs may redirect attention towards the voluntary-contribution decision.

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Dr Chuanzi Yue – Empirical IO **Jun 2026 – Present**
Imperial College London, London, UK
- Assisted an empirical industrial organisation project on Chinese pharmaceutical markets, focusing on how volume-based procurement affects firm incentives and substitution across drug categories.
- Constructed a preliminary Yaodu-Cortellis company-matching workflow using name standardisation, token-based candidate generation, fuzzy matching, LLM-assisted screening, and manual auditing.
- Researched volume-based procurement, pharmaceutical pricing, and Chinese patent medicines, developing a proposal on whether procurement pressure on chemical drugs induces substitution toward Chinese patent medicines.
- Applied principal-agent and credence-goods frameworks to analyse incentive and informational frictions among governments, hospitals, and pharmaceutical firms.

Selected Coursework Project

Panel Data Econometrics Group Project – Shall-Issue Laws and Violent Crime **Mar 2026 – Apr 2026**
University College London, London, UK

- Analysed a 1977-1999 US state-level panel using pooled OLS, state and year fixed effects, and clustered standard errors, showing that the apparent negative association between shall-issue laws and violent crime largely disappears after accounting for state and common time heterogeneity.
- Assessed serial correlation, alternative crime outcomes, instrumental-variable validity, and binary-response models using Python, including logit, probit, linear probability models, and average partial effects.
- Received a mark of 88.5/100 for the project.

Academic Engagement

- Regularly attend UCL Centre for Theoretical and Behavioural Economics (THEBES) seminars.
- Attended the European Economic Theory Conference, London, 2026.

Skills & Activities

Technical Skills*:* Python, Stata*,* LaTeX, Excel, Mathematica.
Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate).
Societies: UCL Economists' Society, UCL Philosophy Society, UCL Japan Society.